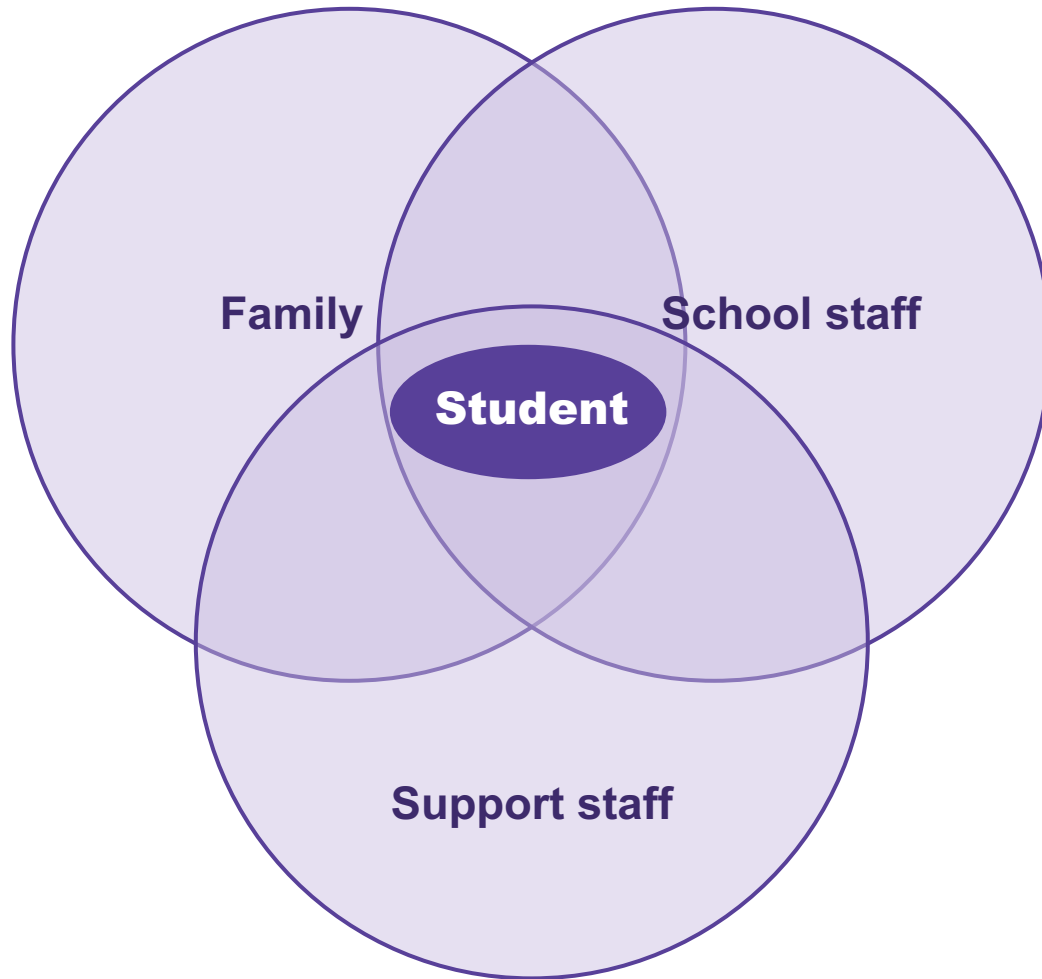




Secondary Education Online · Session 4

Working in Partnership with Students and Families

Working in partnership



What is the goal of these intersecting partnerships?

Every partner brings different knowledge and a different relationship with the student.

The student is at the centre of every partnership.

Power dynamics

Power can sit in:

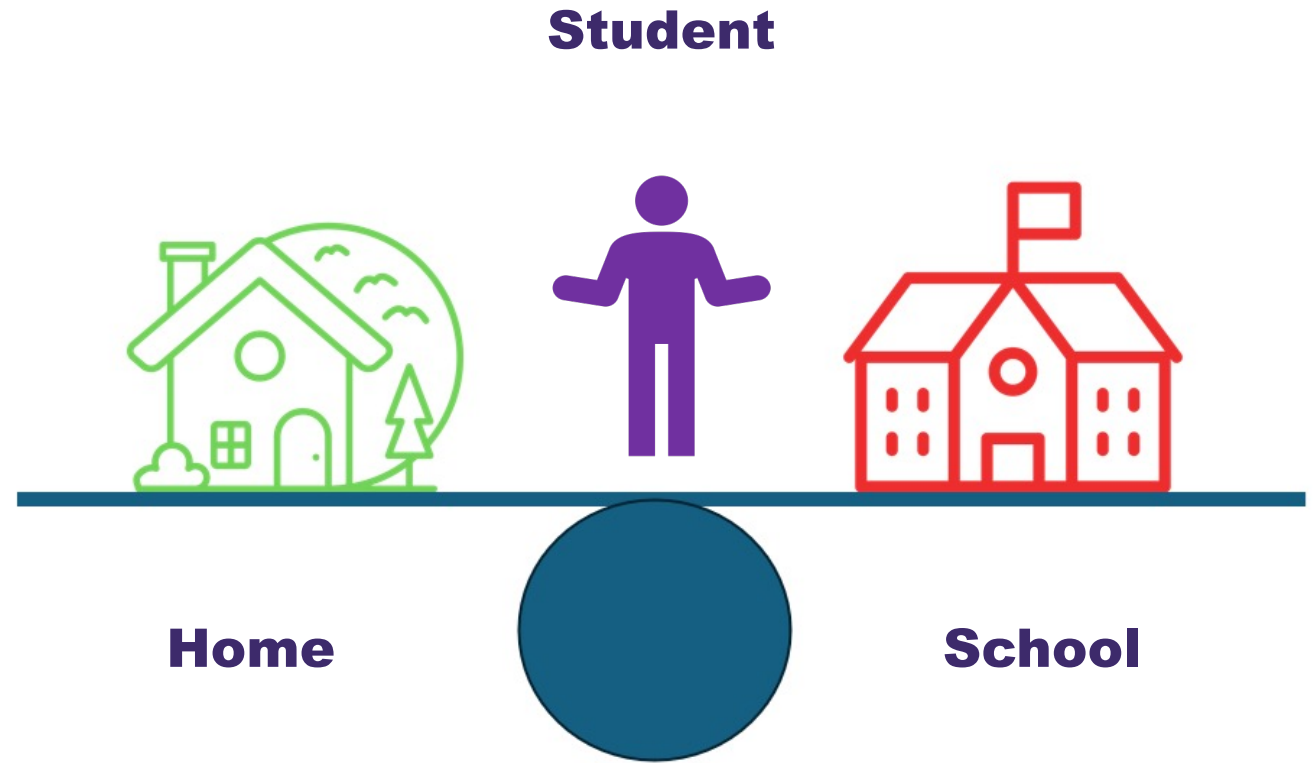
Socio-economic status

Historical / cultural experiences of education

Speaking English vs speaking a language other than English

Pedagogy / understanding of school systems and curriculum

Perception of the importance / experience of school

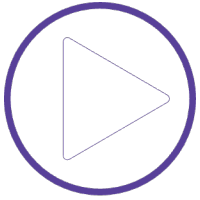


Power dynamics activity

In the chat or on the whiteboard:

- 1 Write an example of an imbalance in power dynamics from a home perspective.
- 2 Write an example of an imbalance in power dynamics from a school perspective.
- 3 Write how you could address these imbalances.

Add your notes to the shared whiteboard under Home, School and Solutions.



Student voice

What decisions were made, and who made them?

What impact did those decisions have on Adon?



Consultation literacy

Useful consultation includes:

A clear, shared purpose

Open questions

More than one way to contribute

Respect for student and family knowledge

Accurate recording of what was heard

An agreed action, responsibility and follow-up

Ask, listen, and follow up.

Under the Disability Standards for Education 2005, schools must consult the student, or an associate such as a parent or carer, about adjustments.

Consulting students and families

With students

Offer communication choices

Meeting preparation

Simple choices

Processing time

Sensory-friendly spaces

Behaviour as communication

Strengths and interests

Support - don't speak for

Clear, accessible questions

With families

Start with students' strengths and interests

Listen to families and value their insights

Use clear, simple language

Respect different perspectives / experiences

Focus on needs, goals and participation

Use real examples from school

Check for shared understanding

Agree on next steps

Keep communication open and ongoing

Adolescents in their own meetings

From being talked about, to taking part and, over time, leading.

Prepared and supported

to take part in their own way: in person, in writing, through a trusted adult.

Taking more of a lead

their own meetings as they move through secondary school.

Speaking up for themselves

is practice for senior school, work and life after school.

Students have a say

in decisions about their own learning and support.

Where you can, ask the student directly.

When student capacity runs out

Discuss capacity without blame. Home and school may observe different parts of the student's experience.

Meltdown

Shutdown

School Can't

Focus on safety, what preceded the situation, what supports recovery and what can change in the environment, task or response.

Bridge to the next family conversation



Prepare for one purposeful conversation.

- What needs to be understood?
- What question will open the conversation?
- How will the student take part, or have their views included?
- What can be decided together?
- How and when will the school follow up?

Keep these notes for your conversation plan later in this session.

Belonging, capacity and joy

Keep all three in the picture.

Belonging

Being recognised,
included and able to
participate as oneself

Capacity

What the day costs,
protects and restores

Joy

Interests, connection and
authentic expression

Return to these when judging whether a change supports flourishing.

Start · Continue · Reconsider

In your Participant Guide, identify:

Start

One strategy to start

something small you can start
next week

Continue

One practice to continue

something this series confirmed
you already do well

Reconsider

**One approach to
reconsider**

something you would now do
differently

For each, decide: How will you know it worked? What evidence will show it?

This plan is yours. Share one thing in the chat if you would like to.

Plan the next conversation

Start from your bridge notes.

- 1 Choose the real conversation you'll have within two weeks:
with a student's family, the student themselves, or a colleague who teaches them
- 2 Plan it in your Participant Guide:
what I'll share (a strength first) · what I'll ask (specifically) · what I'll offer
- 3 Write your opening sentence, word for word
- 4 Note it: when, where, how

Final reflection

In Session 1 you wrote what you hoped to understand. Read your own words back. What's different now?

Where were you at the start of Session 1?

Where are you now?

In one sentence, for yourself: what will you do differently in your teaching?

Connections that continue

What are you curious to learn more about next? Look back at your notes from Session 1: how many of your questions got answered?

Webinars and deep dives

Titles and dates to confirm

Online Community of Practice

Link and QR code TBA

Positive Partnerships website

Resources for educators, families and students

positivepartnerships.com.au

This series is a starting point. These supports continue after it.



Feedback

Feedback link and QR code: TBA

Good luck on your journey

**Stay curious.
Keep students at the centre.**

Take one thoughtful next step, include the people who hold relevant knowledge and review what happens. Small, informed changes can be refined through student voice, observation and partnership.

